

Application launcher

In Windows, the most common way to launch an application is to go to the 'Start' button, then expand *Programs* and select the app. The 'Start' button was so popular that Microsoft had to bring it back in Windows 8.1 on popular demand! The need for a separate utility for an application launcher reduced significantly after operating systems started integrating it into the basic OS interface. For example, after Windows XP, all new OS versions came with the application search field to filter particular applications with a few keystrokes.

Even with inbuilt support from the OS, it still makes sense to use Blaze because you can do a lot more than just opening an application.

Pardoning your mistakes

Blaze is exceptionally good when it comes to excusing typos. If you want to launch Microsoft Word, you can type any of the alternatives for Blaze to identify what you want. You could type 'Word', 'wd', or 'owd'. The hit rate of finding the right application with fewest keystrokes makes you more productive.

Quick file search

In addition to the application launch, Blaze also does document search. Just type a few letters of the filename and you can quickly open the file. Blaze internally has an indexing service that does indexing before the file search operation. Blaze has been optimised for fast indexing and low memory use. It allows you to configure the directories you would like to index and also gives you the option to exclude subdirectories. This utility also has the capability to search the file's contents.

Web search

To search for a term or a topic in Google, you can just invoke Blaze and type 'Google' followed by the term. This will launch the browser and take you to the search results. There are other search services already configured and also an option to configure more. The configured Web search sites are YouTube, Wikipedia, Yahoo, IMDB, Maps, Weather, Bing, and Dictionary. To search a location in Maps, invoke Blaze, type 'Maps' followed by the destination you are looking for.

To configure more search sites, right-click on the Blaze *Taskbar* icon, select *Settings*, then select '*Plugins*', and finally, '*WebSearch*'.

Go to a URL

Blaze has the ability to recognise URLs. Just type a URL and Blaze will launch the browser and open the page. If there is an existing browser instance (that supports tabs), a new tab is opened.



Figure 1: Blaze is ready to take your command

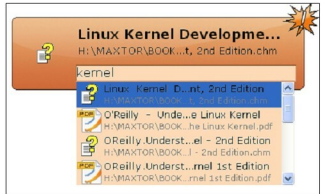


Figure 2: Search for a document with 'kernel' in the filename

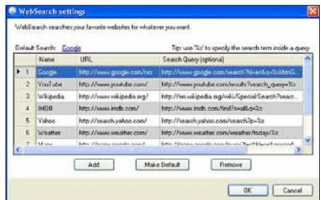


Figure 3: WebSearch plugin configuration screen



Figure 4: A book on Amazon is US \$19.99. How much is it in INR?

Simple calculator

If you want to quickly convert US\$ into INR, compute the percentage of something or do some complex arithmetic, this utility comes handy. You can either invoke Blaze and type in the text field, or select text from an application (like a browser or notepad), invoke Blaze and type 'Solve'.

E-mail quickly

To send an e-mail using the default e-mail client, you just need to invoke Blaze and type: